

Perl files is *.pl* or *.pm*, which is based on a file or module:

```
#!/usr/bin/perl
$abc = 10;
print "Value of abc = $abc\n";
print 'program is over';
```

PHP

PHP is also a general-purpose language but is mainly used for Web development. It's a server-side scripting language designed by Rasmus Lerdorf. It is very popular for small or medium level website development compared to other languages. It is also used by some giant firms like Facebook, YouTube, and Yahoo! Nowadays, there are a lot of frameworks built on PHP, which compete with Python and Perl. Though demand for Python is increasing, PHP is still very popular in both small and large organisations. The current version of PHP is 7.1.2.

Advantages

- Most people prefer PHP when it comes to creating dynamic Web pages, because it's easier to set-up in local host and most of the hosting providers offer built-in PHP support.
- It's easy to use. The syntax is mostly the same as the C language. Anyone can easily adopt it.
- There are lots of frameworks available for PHP and it has immense community support.
- PHP is stable. Since it's used by many developers, code maintenance is very quick.
- PHP has strong database support and provides native session management.
- PHP 7 is much faster than any other versions of PHP.

Disadvantages

- Some of the libraries written in PHP are procedural, so it's difficult for programmers from an object-oriented background.
- Since it is open source, security is the major challenge as the code is available to all; hence, intruders can easily find weaknesses in the code.
- It becomes slow after a certain scale. Because of this, large scale organisations use their own customised frameworks to increase performance.
- PHP is not suitable for desktop applications. Besides, its error handling capabilities are poor.

Popularity

PHP is still very popular and is one of the top-10 languages used by Web developers to create dynamic websites. Web developers should definitely learn PHP to kickstart their careers.

Popular frameworks

Laravel, Symfony, CodeIgniter, Phalcon, etc. are some of the

popular frameworks.

Syntax

PHP scripting code is written using the `<?php` start tag and `>` end tag. The file extension is *.php*, and usually contains PHP scripts and HTML code.

```
<?php // PHP code ?>
```

Python

Python is a general-purpose and high-level programming language designed by Guido van Rossum in the late 1980s. It's very elegant and easy to learn. Nowadays, a beginner's first priority is to learn Python. It supports multiple paradigms —functional, imperative, procedural and OO (object oriented). Python is an all-round language. Since it's often a first choice, it can be found everywhere. It can be used in testing, automation, Web development, data analytics, cloud computing, mobile development and game development. Python uses indentation to identify the block, and this eliminates the need for curly brackets and the colon. Python's philosophy is different, which is, "There is only one way to do the things and it's called the Pythonic way." The current version of Python is 3.6.0.

Advantages

- One of the best things about Python is that it is well documented.
- Python is used in 3D animation and game development, which differentiates it from other languages.
- In school, students learn Python quicker than C or C++ because it is easy.
- Python uses white space indentation, while others use curly braces. Comparatively, Python code is neater and cleaner.
- Code written in Python is very short compared to other languages, which demonstrates its power.
- Python also supports JVM so code written in Python can easily work with some of the Java objects/APIs.
- If you are new to programming, learn Python because by learning this one language, you can easily jump into any field of interest, whether it's automation, Web development, game development or data analytics. Python is everywhere.

Disadvantages

- Indentation is the biggest issue in Python. The code will not work and sometimes people get irritated because of it.
- Python forces programmers to follow a particular convention.
- It's slower compared to older languages like C and C++. It is also an interpreted language.
- It doesn't perform multi-processor/multi-core work efficiently.